

Bursar and finance guide

For bursars and accountants

Billing the term from fee structures and vote heads, recording payments and receipts, bursaries and waivers, fee reminders, and spending through payment vouchers.

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Getting started

Bursars and accountants sign in with their own account like everyone else. The administrator then assigns the duty under Settings → Roles & duties, and its pages appear in the menu the next time you open Skulbase. You only see a page if your school has switched its module on and your role or duty uses it. If something here is missing from your menu, ask your administrator.

1.1 Who this guide is for

The duties this guide covers, and what each one can do.

- Bursar: fees, billing, expenses and financial reports, including approving vouchers.
- Accountant: records payments and expenses; approvals stay with the bursar or principal.

1.2 Activate your account with an invite code

Teachers, staff and learners do not sign up on their own. Your school adds you, and you get a personal invite code (or a link that has the code in it) to set up your login.

Activate your account
Enter the invite code from your school to get started.

Invite code

A 7 X 3 K 9

6 letters and numbers from your school. You can also paste the link you were sent.

Continue →

No code yet? Ask your school administrator. They can send it to you as a link.

Already activated? [Sign in](#)
Setting up a new school? [Create an account](#)
Need help? [Read the user guides](#)

Activating an account: type the invite code from your school, or open the link they sent you.

1 Get your code

Your school administrator gives you a six-character invite code, for example A7X3K9, by SMS, WhatsApp, on paper, or as a link. The code only works for your account.

2 Open the activation page

Tap the link you were sent, or go to skulbase.com, choose Sign in and then “Activate your account”. If you opened a link, the code is already filled in.

3 Check it is you

Press Continue. Skulbase shows the name the school registered. If it is not you, choose “Not you?” and ask the school for the right code.

4 Choose how you will sign in

Pick a username (one is suggested for you) and a password of at least 8 characters, or continue with Google. Adding an email address lets you reset your password yourself later.

5 You are in

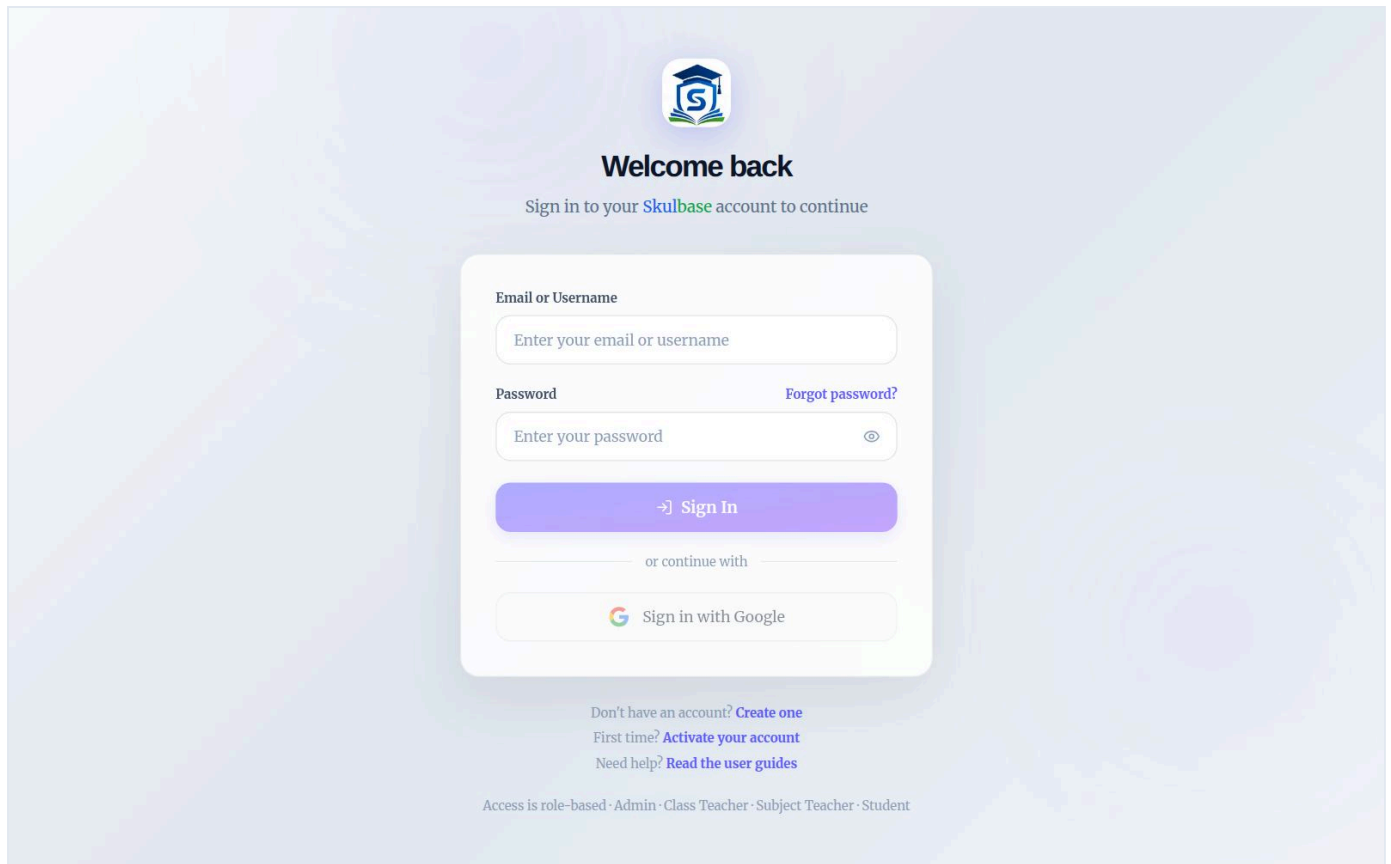
You are signed in straight away and land on the home page for your role.



Good to know: Each code can be used once. If yours says it has expired or was already used, ask your administrator to reset your account; they get a fresh code in seconds.

1.3 Sign in

Once your account is active, sign in with your email address or username and your password, or with Google if you activated with Google.



The sign-in page. “Forgot password?” sends you a code by email.

1 Go to the sign-in page

Open skulbase.com and choose Sign in.

2 Enter your details

Type your email address or username, then your password, and press Sign In. Or press “Sign in with Google”.

3 Forgot your password?

Choose “Forgot password?”, enter your email address, and type the six-digit code we email you along with a new password. This also works if you have only ever used Google, and afterwards both ways work.



Tip: Save skulbase.com to your phone’s home screen. It opens like an app and remembers you are signed in.

1.4 Finding your way around

The menu only shows the pages your role can use. On a computer it runs down the left-hand side; on a phone the main pages sit in a bar along the bottom.

- On a computer, the arrow at the top of the menu makes it narrower (icons only) or wider (icons and names). Skulbase remembers your choice.
- Press the / key, or tap “Search menu”, to jump to any page by typing part of its name.
- Your name at the bottom of the menu opens your account menu: switch between light and dark appearance, or sign out.
- If you hold more than one role (for example an administrator who is also a class teacher), use “View as” in the account menu to switch views.
- On a phone, the bottom bar shows your four most-used pages. Everything else is under More.

Billing the term

Billing sets what each learner owes, from vote heads and fee structures, and bills a whole term in one go.

2.1 Vote heads

Vote heads are the accounts fees are split into (tuition, exams, boarding, transport and so on). Add each with a name, a short code and an allocation order: payments are allocated to vote heads in that order.

2.2 Fee structures

A fee structure is the year's fees for a class level, for day scholars, boarders or both: an amount for the year per vote head, and the share billed each term (for example 50%, 30% and 20%).

Billing: Invoicing, Fee structures, Bursaries & waivers, Day & boarding, and the vote-head statement.

2.3 Day scholars and boarders

On “Day & boarding”, mark each learner as a day scholar or a boarder (a whole class at once, or one by one), so they are billed from the right structure.

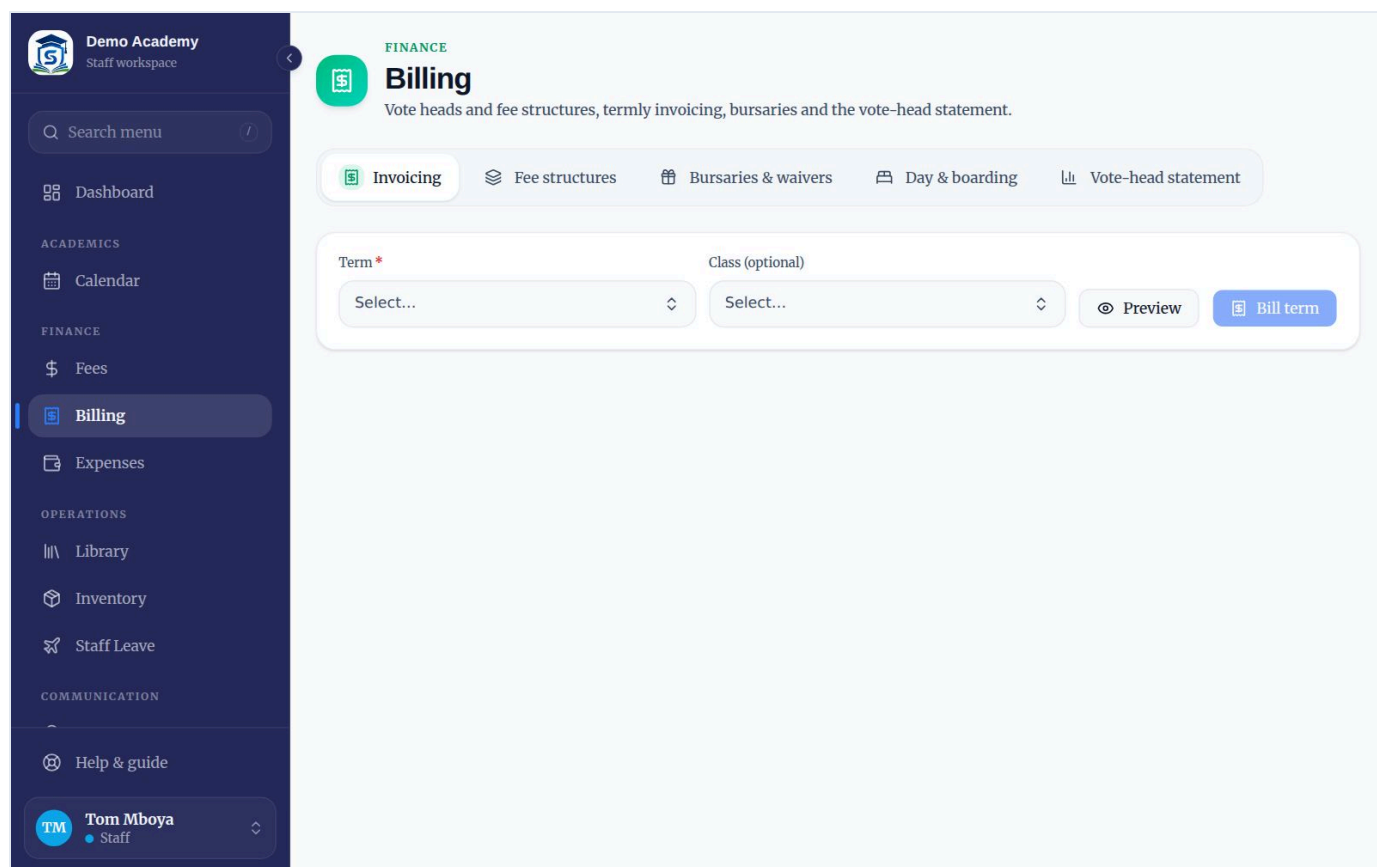
2.4 Bursaries and waivers

Record a bursary, scholarship, waiver or discount for a learner and term: the amount, the sponsor (for example CDF) and a reference. Awards reduce what the learner owes when the term is billed.

Good to know: If you add an award after billing, bill the term again so it is taken off.

2.5 Bill the term

On Invoicing, choose the term (and a class, if you like) and press Preview.



Invoicing: preview first, then bill the term.

1 Preview

Every learner is listed with the amount from their structure, less any awards. Learners with no structure are skipped and listed so you can fix them.

2

Bill

Press “Bill term” and confirm. Each learner’s fee record for the term is created or updated on the Fees page.

2.6 Vote-head statement and reminders

The vote-head statement shows, for a term, what was billed and collected under each vote head. “Balance reminders” texts the guardians of learners who owe at least an amount you choose.

Fees and payments

The Fees page is where each learner's balance lives and where payments are recorded.

3.1 Fee records

Choose the term to see what is expected, collected, outstanding and overdue, with a collection progress bar and one row per learner.

FINANCE Fees
Bill students each term, record payments and track what is still owed.

Term: Term 3 · 2026 [Export] [Add record]

Fee records | Payments | Batch entry

EXPECTED
KSh 810,000
18 records

COLLECTED
KSh 456,000
56% collection rate

OUTSTANDING
KSh 354,000
unpaid balance

OVERDUE
KSh 0
0 overdue record(s)

Collection progress: 56% collected · Moderate

Search student or admission no. [All statuses] [All classes]

18 record(s)

STUDENT	EXPECTED FEE	PAID	BALANCE	STATUS	LAST PAYMENT ACTIVITY	
Amani Otieno 2400 · Term 3	45,000	45,000	0	Paid	Just now	[Pay] [History] [Edit] [Delete]
Wanjiku Kamau 2401 · Term 3	45,000	20,000	25,000	Partial	1d ago	[Pay] [History] [Edit] [Delete]
Kevin Ouma 2402 · Term 3	45,000	0	45,000	Pending	2d ago	[Pay] [History] [Edit] [Delete]

Fees → Fee records.

- Pay records a payment; the clock icon shows a learner's payment history with receipts.
- “Batch entry” bills or records payments for a whole class at once.
- “Export” downloads the term as a spreadsheet.

3.2 Record a payment

For cash, cheques, bank deposits and M-Pesa messages you receive yourself. Online payments made from the learner's or parent's Fees page are recorded automatically.

Record payment.

1 Press Pay

On the learner's row.

2 Enter it

The amount (filled with the balance; change it for a part payment), the date paid, the method and, optionally, who paid and a note.

3 Save and give a receipt

The balance updates at once and the receipt is in the payment history.

3.3 The payments log and unmatched payments

The Payments tab lists every payment, filtered by date, method and status. M-Pesa or bank payments that could not be matched to a learner (for example a wrong account number) appear with a button to assign them.

Expenses

Every shilling spent goes through a payment voucher, so spending can be tracked by vote head and supplier.

4.1 Payment vouchers

The Expenses tab shows totals awaiting approval, approved but unpaid, paid and rejected, and every voucher.

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Expenses

Raise payment vouchers, approve them, and track spending by vote head and supplier.

Expenses Suppliers

AWAITING APPROVAL **Ksh 28,300**

APPROVED, UNPAID **Ksh 42,000**

PAID **Ksh 27,600**

REJECTED **0**

Search expenses

+ Record expense

EXPENSE	AMOUNT	DATE	VOTE HEAD	STATUS	RAISED BY
Printing Endterm papers	Ksh 18,500	26 Sept 2026	Exams	Pending	Joseph Kiprono
Science lab chemicals	Ksh 42,000	23 Sept 2026	Tuition	Approved	Joseph Kiprono
Bus service – KDA 123A	Ksh 27,600	18 Sept 2026	Transport	Paid	Tom Mboya
Kitchen gas refill	Ksh 9,800	25 Sept 2026	Boarding	Pending	Ruth Wanjiru

Expenses: approve, reject and mark vouchers paid.

1 Raise a voucher

Press “Record expense”: what it is for, the amount, date, supplier, vote head, payment method and invoice reference. Staff raise their own under “My requests”.

2 Approve or reject (bursar, principal)

Use Approve or Reject on each pending voucher.

3 Pay it

When you pay an approved voucher, press Paid and enter who was paid and the reference (cheque number or M-Pesa code).

4.2 Suppliers

The Suppliers tab keeps each supplier's name, phone, email, KRA PIN and category, so vouchers pick them from a list.

Getting help

Most questions are answered on the page itself: many pages have a “How to” panel at the bottom. For anything else, these are the places to go.

5.1 Where to get help

This guide is always available from Help in the menu, and as a PDF you can download and print.

- Your school administrator can add or reset accounts, fix classes and subjects, and change school settings.
- For problems with Skulbase itself, use the contact page at skulbase.com/contact, or call 0740 129 444.
- When you report a problem, say which page you were on, what you pressed and what you expected. A screenshot helps.